Beth Anne Helgason

Yale School of Management
165 Whitney Avenue, New Haven, CT 06511
ba.helgason@yale.edu | bahelgason.com

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Yale School of Management 2024-present
Assistant Professor of Organizational Behavior

EDUCATION

London Business School 2024
Ph.D. in Organizational Behavior
Visiting Scholar, UC Berkeley Haas School of Business 2022

Smith School of Business, Queen's University
M.Sc. in Organizational Behavior

Queen's University
B.Sc. in Psychology with Honors

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

†denotes equal authorship

†Langdon, J.A., †Helgason, B.A., Qiu, J., & Effron, D.A. (2024). "It's not literally true, but you get the gist": How nuanced understandings of truth encourage people to condone and spread misinformation. *Current Opinion in Psychology, 57,* 101788.

Kundro, T.G., Croitoru, N.L., & Helgason, B.A. (2024). Moral or lawful? When legal constraints reverse the motivational benefits of moral considerations. *Organization Science, 35*(5), 1849-1865.

Effron, D.A., & Helgason, B.A. (2023). Moral inconsistency. *Advances in Experimental Social Psychology*, 67, 1-72.

Helgason, B.A., & Effron, D.A. (2022). It might become true: How prefactual thinking licenses dishonesty. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, *123*(5), 909-940.

Helgason, B.A., & Berman, J.Z. (2022). Reflecting on identity change facilitates confession of past misdeeds. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, 151*(9), 2259-2264.

Effron, D.A., & Helgason, B.A. (2022). The moral psychology of misinformation: Why we excuse dishonesty in a post-truth world. *Current Opinion in Psychology*, *47*, 101375.

Helgason, B.A., & Effron, D.A. (2022). From critical to hypocritical: Counterfactual thinking increases partisan disagreement about media hypocrisy. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology, 101*, 104308.

UNDER REVIEW OR REVISION

Helgason, B.A., & Effron, D.A. Advice as permission: Licensing self-interest by selectively seeking and taking advice. *Minor revision at Management Science.*

Helgason, B.A., Langdon, J.A., Qiu, J., & Effron, D.A. Taking the ingroup seriously but the outgroup literally: Political polarization and flexible standards of honesty. *Major revision at Psychological Science.*

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Helgason, B.A., & Gurudevan, R. How do Americans use AI to prepare for elections? Using real voter prompts to build evaluations of AI political persuasion.

Wang, B., & Helgason, B.A. Pressure-testing when and how large language models mislead without saying anything false.

Geiser, A.E., & Helgason, B.A. Domain (in)consistency in the risk preferences of large language models.

Dillion, D., Helgason, B.A., Wang, B., Gray, K., & Galesic, M. AI moral guidance and personalization across cultures.

Dillion, D., Galesic, M., Gray, K. Atari, M., Singh, M., Tandon, N., Barolo, D., Helgason, B.A., & Wang, B. The global virtues atlas for culturally enriched AI.

Helgason, B.A., Gupta, A., Konczak, T.F., Wei, L., & Talhelm, T. Half-truths across cultures: Condemnation of palters and truthy lies in the U.S., U.K., China, and India.

Dillion, D., Chen, C.L., Wang, B., Galesic, M., & Helgason, B.A. The moral values alignment pipeline.

Helgason, B.A., & Effron, D.A. Algorithmic license: People selectively use hiring algorithms' advice to justify race-based evaluations.

AWARDS, GRANTS, & HONORS

John Templeton Foundation Grant, "Global Virtues Atlas" (PI: Danica Dillion; core team member; $1.1M; 2026)
Dean's Office Research Grant, Yale SOM (with Balazs Kovacs; $50K; 2025)
Cecilia Reyes Award, London Business School (2023)

The Leadership Institute Research Grant, London Business School (2022)
Doctoral Fellowship, SSHRC of Canada (2019)
Joseph-Armand Bombardier Graduate Scholarship, SSHRC of Canada (2019)
Queen's Graduate Award, Smith School of Business (2018)
Medal in Psychology, Queen's University
Ann Adamson Scholarship in Psychology, Queen's University
Carl Reinhardt Scholarship in Physics, Queen's University

INVITED TALKS

The Ohio State University, Mind and Machine Alignment Summit (2026)
University of Chicago, Booth School of Business (2023)
Yale University, Yale School of Management (2023)
University of Toronto Scarborough, Rotman School of Management (2023)
University of Southern California, Marshall School of Business (2023)
Duke University, The Fuqua School of Business (2023)
Harvard University, Harvard Business School (2023)

CHAIRED SYMPOSIA

Helgason, B.A., & Effron, D.A. (2025). Political polarization and misinformation: Mechanisms and interventions. Society of Experimental Social Psychology, Lisbon.

Helgason, B.A. (2023). AI ethics in the workplace: Challenges and opportunities. Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Boston.

Helgason, B.A. (2022). Prompting and punishing transgressions: Interpersonal causes and consequences of unethical behavior. Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Seattle.

Helgason, B.A. (2021). Intertemporal insights on moral judgment and decision making. Society for Personality and Social Psychology, online.

Helgason, B.A., & Fa-Kaji, N.M. (2020). Believing is seeing: Motivated reasoning, moral judgments, and divergent perceptions of social issues. Academy of Management Annual Meeting, online.

SELECTED CONFERENCE TALKS

Cultural differences in condemning half-truths

- *International Association for Conflict Management*, Vienna (2026)
- *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Philadelphia (2026)

Political polarization and flexible standards of honesty

- *Political Psychology Preconference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology,* Chicago (2026)
- *International Association for Conflict Management*, Burlington (2025)
- *Society of Experimental Social Psychology,* Lisbon (2025)

The social transmission of dishonesty
- *Berkeley Haas Culture Connect Conference*, Berkeley (2025)

Algorithmic license
- *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Boston (2023)
- *International Association for Conflict Management*, Thessaloniki (2023)

When legal constraints reverse the motivational benefits of moral considerations
- *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Boston (2023)

Advice as permission: Licensing self-interest by selectively seeking and taking advice
- *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Seattle (2022)
- *International Association for Conflict Management*, online (2021)

It might become true: How prefactual thinking licenses dishonesty
- *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Seattle (2022)
- *Justice and Morality Preconference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology*, online (2022)
- *Society for Judgment and Decision Making*, online (2020)

Reflecting on identity change facilitates confession of past misdeeds
- *Society for Judgment and Decision Making*, online (2022)
- *Society for Personality and Social Psychology*, online (2021)

Counterfactual thinking increases partisan disagreement about media hypocrisy
- *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, online (2020)
- *International Association for Conflict Management*, Dublin (2019)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Business Ethics (2025-present)
EMBA, MBA, and Master's in Asset Management programs at Yale SOM

SELECTED MEDIA MENTIONS

CNN, CTV News, Financial Times, Harvard Business Review, Psychology Today, Think at London Business School

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Journal Reviewing (ad hoc)
Journal of Experimental Psychology: General; Journal of Personality and Social Psychology; Management Science; Nature Reviews Psychology; Organization Science; Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin; Psychological Science; Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences; Social Justice Research